Design Thinking – DST511s

Practical

Dear Students,

Ideation stage

Generate ideas and potential solutions (1 hour)

The third phase in the Design Thinking process consists of ideation—coming up with ideas and potential solutions to solve the user's problem.ariety?

Start by introducing an ideation technique of your choice. For this example, we'll use the worst possible idea technique followed by a simple brainstorm. You can learn about different ideation techniques in this comprehensive guide to ideation in Design Thinking.

You might break the ideation phase up as follows:

- **Presentation (5 minutes):** What is ideation? What ideation technique will the group be using today, and how does it work? Provide a few examples to help them get started.
- **Activity—worst possible idea (10 minutes):** Using the "worst possible idea" technique, ask the group to spend around ten minutes coming up with "anti-solutions" to the problem they're trying to solve.
- **Activity—coming up with solutions (10 minutes):** Having explored the opposite of what would be helpful to the user, it should now be easier to find potential solutions. Get the group to spend another ten minutes brainstorming as many ideas as possible. They can use words or sketches.
- **Activity—sharing ideas and getting feedback (10 minutes):** Ask participants to pair up and share their ideas. This step is all about gathering useful feedback: Are the ideas good? Why, or why not?
- **Activity—refining your solution (10 minutes):** Incorporating what they've learned about the user and the feedback they received on their initial ideas, it's time for the Design Thinkers to pull everything into one single solution. For this activity, encourage participants to sketch out their solution rather than using words.
- **Reflection and discussion (5 minutes):** As a group, discuss what you've learned from the ideation phase so far.

Now you'll introduce a key UX design tool into the mix: user journey maps.

As explained by the Nielsen Norman Group, a journey map is a visualization of the process that a person goes through in order to accomplish a goal. In the second part of the ideation phase, you'll get your participants to compile a series of user actions into a timeline. Then they'll add desires and pain-points for each step in the user's journey, based on the one solution they decided on previously. For this part of the workshop, participants will need plenty of Post-it notes and a large surface to work on—such as a table, wall, or whiteboard.

Pssst you may use Canva or any other online tool for collaboration as a group in the absence of a post-it notes and a large surface to work on.

You can divide the journey mapping phase of your Design Thinking workshop into the following activities:

- **Presentation (10 minutes):** What is a user journey map? Why do we need to create one, and what steps are involved?
- **Activity—define the activities and steps in the customer's experience (15 minutes):** Ask participants to write down all the steps they can think of that make up the user's journey. For example: Downloads the app, creates an account, uploads a profile photo, browses through potential matches, receives a match, sends a message. For the last 5 minutes, participants should combine any steps that are too similar, narrowing it down to 8-15 steps.
- **Activity—group the steps into phases (10 minutes):** Participants will now group the steps from the last activity into phases, aiming for 3-7 phases in total. Phases should be labelled from the user's perspective. For example: Getting started, browsing the app, interacting with other users, etc.
- **Activity—adding goals and pain-points (15 minutes):** Ask participants to come up with goals and pain-points that relate to each step in the user journey. Goals are what propel the user from one step to the next, while pain-points prevent the user from moving forward. For example: The step "browses through potential matches" could be propelled by the user goal of wanting to meet new people. A pain-point could be that they don't find any suitable matches in the local area.
- **Sharing user journey maps, reflection and discussion (10 minutes):** At the end of the ideation phase, put ten minutes aside for presenting and reflecting on all the user journey maps created.

Thank you for making time to complete these practical activities.